

Backgrounds

Backgrounds make or break a photo. A flower photographed against a busy background gets lost. If the background is out of focus and soft, a sharp flower will stand out against it. Luckily, depth of field in close-ups can be quite shallow so it's usually not a problem making the background soft. You just open up to a wide aperture such as $f/2$ or $f/3.5$ and focus on the flower. Anything behind the flower will be soft and the farther away it is from the flower, the softer it will be.

One special technique is to use a light tent. You could cut the bottom out of it to position it over a flower. It not only softens and diffuses the light and cuts the wind, when positioned in the right way, it gives you a uniform grey or white background. This kind of background is very easy to select in a photo-editing program, so you can remove it all together, replace it with a different colour, or even cut and paste the flower into another scene. If the background is busy, this is time-consuming if not impossible.